WARIS AHMAD FAIZI

warisahmad@vt.edu
warisfaizi.github.io
Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech
555 McBryde Hall, 225 Stanger Street, Blacksburg, VA 24061
Google Scholar LinkedIn GitHub VT Experts

EDUCATION

2024–	Ph.D., Sociology, Virginia Tech *Areas of Specialization*: Economic Sociology; Knowledge, Data, and Technology *Areas of Research Interest*: Labor, Work, and Organizations; Global Political Economy; Computational Social Science
2026	Graduate Certificate, Future Professoriate, Virginia Tech
Mar–Jul 2024	Visiting Graduate Student, University of Tübingen, Germany (Erasmus+ and DAAD)
2023	M.A., Sociology, American University of Central Asia Exchange semester (Erasmus+), Otto-von-Guericke University Magdeburg, Germany, 2022
Mar–Aug 2022	Visiting Graduate Student, Otto-von-Guericke University Magdeburg, Germany (Erasmus+)
2020	M.A., Economics, OSCE Academy in Bishkek
2015	B.A., Economics, Kabul University

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2026–	Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech Project Manager, GRASS Project (social dimensions of regenerative grazing; mixed-methods interviews and surveys), USDA-NRCS–funded Virginia Tech–West Virginia University collaboration; PI: Dr. Liesel Ritchie
Aug 2026	Fellow, Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), Stanford University
Jul–Aug 2026	Teaching Assistant, ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan *Course*: Categorical Data Analysis: Models for Categorical, Ordinal, and Count Outcomes
May–Jun 2026	Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech
2025–26	Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech
May–Jul 2025	Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech
2024–25	Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2026–	Research Team Member, post-institute research project of the Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), Stanford University: LLM-agent simulations of online polarization (built the ANES-derived agent population)

2023–24	Research Consultant, International Finance Corporation (IFC), World Bank Group October 2023 – May 2024
2022–23	Research Intern, Office of the Vice President for Academic Affairs, American University of Central Asia
2020–22	Intern, Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE) Secretariat September–October 2020; November 2021 – February 2022 (six months)
2021	Research Consultant, World Bank Project, Pearl Horizon Consulting
2021	Research Fellow, Central Asia Program, George Washington University
2021	Research Intern, Center for Research and Graduate Education (CRGE), Kazakh-German University (DKU)

AWARDS & HONORS

2026	Dean's Graduate Scholar, College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences, Virginia Tech Includes the CLAHS Fellowship Award
2026	Center for Humanities Graduate Student Fellowship, Virginia Tech
2026	Travel Fund Program (TFP) Award, Graduate and Professional Student Senate, Virginia Tech (for ASA 2026)
2025	Patricia and John Edwards Fellowship Award, Virginia Tech
2024	Erasmus+ Exchange Scholarship, University of Tübingen, Germany
2023	German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) Scholarship, Germany
2023	Student Initiative Development Program Fund, Center for Civic Engagement, American University of Central Asia
2022	Erasmus+ Exchange Scholarship, Otto-von-Guericke University (OVGU), Germany
2021	Central Asia Program Research Fellowship, George Washington University
2021	M.A. Sociology Program Full Scholarship, American University of Central Asia
2019	M.A. Economics Program Full Scholarship, OSCE Academy in Bishkek

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

J2 Calasanti, T., **Faizi, W. A.** & King, N. *The Importance of Age Inequality for Intersectional Scholarship: The Case of the Workplace. Sociology Compass* **20**(10), e70263 (2026). Open access. https://doi.org/10.1111/soc4.70263

J1 **Faizi, W. A.**, Kim, D., Dogan, C., Park, S. & Kim, J. *Mapping Workforce Reskilling Urgency in the Age of AI: Occupational and Geographic Patterns across the United States. Telematics and Informatics* **109**, 102445 (2026). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tele.2026.102445

Revise and Resubmit

RR1 **Faizi, W. A.** *From Perk to Norm: The Diffusion of Remote Work and the Divergence of Its Satisfaction and Pay.* Revise and resubmit at *Social Currents*; revised manuscript under review. 2026.

Manuscripts under Review

R2 Roos, J. M., **Faizi, W. A.** & Lin, S.-H. *Confidence in Science and US Political Institutions, 2010–2024: Four Distinct Patterns of Polarization, or the 'Politicization Pitchfork'*. Under review at *Social Science Research*. 2026.

R1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Autonomy, Precarity, and Stratified Returns Across Employment Sectors.* Under review at *Sociological Forum*. 2026.

Manuscripts in Preparation

M2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Pricing Care Labor: The Devaluation of Bodywork and the Intersectional Division of Reproductive Labor.* In preparation. 2026.

M1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Timing of Corporate Elite Mobility.* Ready for submission to *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*. 2026.

Works in Progress

W5 **Faizi, W. A.** *Neoliberal Doxa across the World-System: Economic Beliefs in the Global North and South.*

W4 **Faizi, W. A.** *Not All Moves Are Equal: How Employment and Capital Composition Shape Residential Mobility Strategies.*

W3 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity.*

W2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024.*

W1 Roos, J. M., **Faizi, W. A.** & Lin, S.-H. *Item Level Bias in the NSF-sponsored Science Knowledge Scale, 2006–2024.*

Research Reports

P1 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Future of the CASA-1000 Electric Megaproject in the Context of the New Afghanistan.* Central Asia Program, George Washington University (2021). centralasiaprogram.org/archive/central-asia-research-paper/

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

C14 **Faizi, W. A.** *From Perk to Norm: The Diffusion of Remote Work and the Divergence of Its Satisfaction and Pay.* Population Association of America (PAA), 2027 Annual Meeting (Seattle, WA, USA). Apr. 2027.

C13 **Faizi, W. A.** *Not All Moves Are Equal: How Employment and Capital Composition Shape Residential Mobility Strategies.* Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS), 50th Annual Meeting (New Brunswick, NJ, USA). Oct. 2026.

C12 **Faizi, W. A.** *Neoliberal Doxa across the World-System: Economic Beliefs in the Global North and South.* Mid-South Sociological Association (MSSA), 52nd Annual Conference (Huntsville, AL, USA). Oct. 2026.

C11 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Timing of Corporate Elite Mobility.* American Sociological Association (ASA), 121st Annual Meeting (New York, NY, USA). Aug. 2026.

C10 **Faizi, W. A.** *Pricing Care Labor: The Devaluation of Bodywork and the Intersectional Division of Reproductive Labor.* Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP), 76th Annual Meeting (New York, NY, USA). Aug. 2026.

C9 **Faizi, W. A.** *Social Capital and the Geography of Opportunity: Economic Connectedness, Bias, and Mobility in the United States.* Southern Sociological Society (SSS) Annual Meeting (Jacksonville, FL, USA). Apr. 2026.

C8 **Faizi, W. A.** *Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024.* 42nd Annual GPSS Research Symposium and Exposition, Virginia Tech (Blacksburg, VA, USA). Mar. 2026.

C7 **Faizi, W. A.** *The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity.* Eastern Sociological Society (ESS), 96th Annual Meeting (Washington, DC, USA). Mar. 2026.

C6 **Faizi, W. A.** *Redistribution Gap: Class, Race and Political Ideology in Shaping Attitudes Toward Inequality.* Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS), 49th Annual Meeting (Columbus, OH, USA). Nov. 2025.

C5 **Faizi, W. A.** *Economic Precarity, Quality of Work Life, and Social Trust: An Empirical Study of the U.S. Workforce (2004–2024).* Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP) Annual Meeting (Chicago, IL, USA). Aug. 2025.

C4 **Faizi, W. A.** *Public, Private, or Personal: Comparative Impacts of Government, Private, and Self-Employment on Job and Financial Satisfaction in the United States.* Canadian Association for Work and Labour Studies (CAWLS) (Hamilton, ON, Canada). May 2025.

C3 **Faizi, W. A.** *Digital Transformation and Work Paradigm's Shift: Remote Work's Impact on Social Networks and Integration, Well-being, and Economic Stability in the United States.* Southern Sociological Society (SSS) Annual Meeting (Charlotte, NC, USA). Apr. 2025.

C2 **Faizi, W. A.** *Efficacy of Human Skills Development as a Source of Regional Competitive Advantage and Economic Development in Afghanistan.* South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM) (Colombo, Sri Lanka). Apr. 2016.

C1 **Faizi, W. A.** *Afghan Carpets' Export Situation: Challenges and Opportunities.* South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM) (Thimphu, Bhutan). Dec. 2014.

MEDIA COVERAGE

2026 Research featured in *VT News*, "How urgently do AI-exposed jobs need retraining?" (Sept. 17, 2026), on the *Telematics and Informatics* reskilling-urgency study
https://news.vt.edu/articles/2026/09/cnre-rui.html

2026 Coverage republished by *Technology.org* (Sept. 28, 2026)
https://www.technology.org/2026/09/28/how-urgently-do-ai-exposed-jobs-need-retraining/

TEACHING

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan

2026 Teaching Assistant, Categorical Data Analysis: Models for Categorical, Ordinal, and Count Outcomes, Graduate

Virginia Tech

2024–26	Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 1004: Introductory Sociology, Undergraduate
2024–26	Graduate Teaching Assistant, SOC 3204: Social Research Methods, Undergraduate
2024–26	Graduate Teaching Assistant, AFST 1814: Introduction to African Studies, Undergraduate
2024–26	Graduate Teaching Assistant, AFST 4354: Topics in Africana Studies, Undergraduate

Prior Teaching Appointments

2019–21	Lecturer / Instructor, Gawharshad University
2019–21	Lecturer / Instructor, Tolo-e-Aftab Institute of Higher Education
2016–21	Lecturer / Instructor, Sayed Jamaluddin Afghan Institute of Higher Education
2016–18	Lecturer / Instructor, Fanoos Institute of Higher Education

Pedagogical Training

2025–26 Future Professoriate / Global Perspectives Program (GPP), Virginia Tech

- Preparing Future Professoriate (3 credits), Fall 2025
- Contemporary Pedagogy (3 credits), Spring 2026
- Higher Education 360 (3 credits), Spring 2026

SERVICE

2026	Manuscript Reviewer, *Social Indicators Research*
Jan–Jun 2026	Graduate Research Fellow, Center for Humanities (CfH), Virginia Tech
2023	Career Development Mentor / Trainer, American University of Central Asia

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Current	American Sociological Association (ASA); Southern Sociological Society (SSS); Eastern Sociological Society (ESS); Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP); Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS); Pacific Sociological Association (PSA); Mid-South Sociological Association (MSSA)
Affiliations	Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality (CPI), Stanford University; Center for Future Work Places and Practices (CFWPP), Virginia Tech; Dataism Laboratory for Quantitative Finance (DLQF), Virginia Tech; Center for Humanities (CfH), Virginia Tech

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical	R, Python, Stata, SPSS, JMP
Other	SQL and database management, ArcGIS Online, LaTeX (Overleaf), high-performance computing (Virginia Tech ARC)

ADVANCED METHODS TRAINING

Summer 2026 ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research, University of Michigan

- Categorical Data Analysis: Models for Categorical, Ordinal, and Count Outcomes
- Causal Inference for the Social Sciences II
- Network Analysis II: Advanced Topics
- Structural Equation Models with Latent Variables

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & TRAINING

2026	Pursuing a Postdoc Proactively series, Office of Postdoctoral Affairs, Virginia Tech (Oct.–Nov. 2026)
2026	Social Network Analysis, University of California, Davis (Coursera)
2026	Causal Inference, Columbia University (Coursera)
2026	Social and Economic Networks: Models and Analysis, Stanford University (Coursera)
2026	Narrative Economics, Yale University (Coursera)
2026	Best Practices for Mentorship in Teaching, Virginia Tech
2026	Introduction to Geospatial Mapping and ArcGIS Online, Virginia Tech
2026	Manage Your Scholarly Identity Challenge Course, Virginia Tech
2026	Connect to ARC Systems with VSCode; Advanced Research Computing Roadmap, Virginia Tech
2026	The Joyful Journey: Graduate Student and Postdoctoral Scholar Professional Development Series, CIRTL
2025	Day for Data, AI & Analytics Symposium, Center for the Arts, Virginia Tech
2025	Datapalooza 2025: Truth and Accountability in the Age of AI, University of Virginia School of Data Science
2025	Preparing for the Academic Job Market Workshop Series, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
2025	Summer Institute for Undergraduate Education, Virginia Tech
2025	Introduction to LaTeX with Overleaf; Introduction to Database Management and SQL, Virginia Tech
2024	Social & Behavioral Research, CITI Basic Course
2024	Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA) Workshop Series, Virginia Tech
2021–25	Courses in Python and R, LinkedIn Learning and DataCamp

REFERENCES

Toni Calasanti, Ph.D.
Professor of Sociology
Director of Graduate Studies
Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA 24061
toni@vt.edu

J. Micah Roos, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Sociology
Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA 24061
jmroos@vt.edu

Liesel Ritchie, Ph.D.
Professor of Sociology
Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA 24061
liesel14@vt.edu

Last updated: October 9, 2026